amalgamation of the TIB swelled both capital and deposits at the Central Bank. In January 1926, the deposits of the bank were at ₹15.93 crores despite the worldwide depression in trade that was affecting banking in the world. Twenty years after the founding of the bank, the figure stood at ₹15.21 crores and in June 1935 it was ₹25.58 crores despite an economic downturn. Such growth came despite being obstructed by prejudice and hostility at every step, and one can only speculate as to how much more could have been achieved had circumstances been more propitious.

The Central Bank also facilitated financing of agriculture in the United Provinces (UP) and Punjab where the rural sector suffered greatly due to lack of credit. 'Thus was initiated what could be called a judicious mixture of banking-cum-development banking as distinguished from purely commercial banking as was the general practice among British banks before the Second World War. This mixed banking was suited to Indian conditions and was a forerunner of the system as it is today after nationalization in the interests of a balanced development of the nation's economy.'[3] Sorabji had realized that the problem was not so much the lack of money but its wide dispersal in the hands of those who hoarded it. It was necessary to bring latent resources into the economy and to this end he opened many strategically placed branches.

The Central Bank established its presence in the Punjab when it opened a branch in Lahore in June 1918. Sorabji's motives for this expansion are best described in his own words. Speaking at the opening he said, 'Very large industries are bound to rise in India in the next few years but the small honest Indian trader and business people will continue to play a vitally important part in the economy of our national life, and to strengthen and support them is a duty which true patriotism as well as self-interest imposes on us. The Punjab is the land par excellence of the sturdy peasant proprietor and enterprising small trader and businessman. And a bank which keeps its interest in the forefront of its objective has surely a wide and beneficent scope in this province.'[4]

Twenty-four pay-offices were opened in the Punjab between 1932 and 1934 with advances being made against wheat, gram, and cotton. Additionally, investment agents and guarantee brokers were appointed for the benefit of traders dealing in agricultural produce. By 1925, the Lahore branch was well-established and enjoyed a reputation for straightforward